

# Your website should cost \$12 a year.

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[shortforge.dev/websites](http://shortforge.dev/websites)

I'm a software engineer in Chicago. For seven years I've built systems for global banks and, right now, one of the largest food and beverage companies in the country. On the side I build websites for small businesses: fast, simple, and yours outright. No monthly platform bill, and **about \$12 a year** to keep online.

## WHAT EVERY SITE COMES WITH

### Works on a phone

Most of your customers will find you on a phone. The site is built for that first, not shrunk down to fit.

### Hours, location, map

The three things people actually came looking for, above the fold, on every device.

### Your photos, done right

Resized and compressed so a gallery of twenty pictures does not take thirty seconds to load.

### Loads fast

Hand-written code, no page builder underneath. Pages open in about a second, even on a weak connection.

### A contact form that works

Messages land in your inbox. No plugin to maintain, nothing to log into.

### Findable on Google

Real page titles, descriptions, and structured data so search engines can read what you sell and when you are open.

## HOW IT WORKS

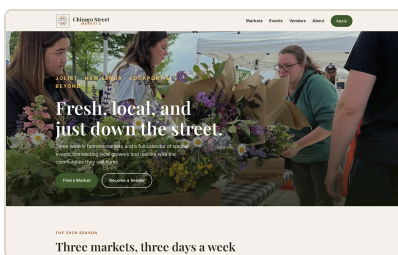
**We talk for twenty minutes.** Usually a phone call. What you sell, who buys it, what you want the site to do. I tell you which package fits and what it costs. No charge, no pitch deck.

**You send me your stuff.** Logo, photos, hours, addresses, social links. One form, one time. If you do not have good photos I will tell you honestly.

**I build it and you look at it.** You get a private link before anything is public. You tell me what to change. That is what the rounds of changes are for.

**It goes live in your name.** The domain and the hosting get set up in accounts that belong to you, with your email and your credit card. I walk you through it and then hand over the keys.

## RECENT WORK



### chicagostreetmarkets.com:

three weekly farmers markets in Joliet, New Lenox and Lockport. Nine pages, a full event calendar, vendor applications and a mailing list. Moved off a one-page Squarespace site; now runs for about \$12 a year, entirely in the owner's own accounts.

**You own all of it:** the domain, the hosting account, the code. Registered in your name, handed over at launch.

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## WHAT IT COSTS

### One Page

**\$1,200**

Everything on a single page. Ready in 2 weeks.

### Storefront

**\$2,800**

A real site with room to grow. Ready in 4-5 weeks.

### Custom Build

**from \$5,000**

Selling online, or moving off something else. Timeline set with the scope.

Vendor rate, 15% off, for anyone selling at Chicago Street Markets. Half up front, half at launch.

## AFTER IT'S LIVE

Care plan · **first year included**

**\$45/mo**

Season change

**\$250**

On your own

**\$0**

Anything else is \$110/hr. Nothing renews on its own.

## ADD-ONS

Extra page

**\$250**

Move off Squarespace / Wix / Etsy, with redirects

**\$400**

Email list setup + first newsletter template

**\$300**

Online ordering (Square or Shopify) added

**\$450**

Flyer / poster set, three web-ready sizes

**\$150**

AI phone agent: setup and first month

**\$1,200**

## WORTH KNOWING UP FRONT

Photos and copy are due within two weeks of starting. If a project goes quiet for a month it gets paused, and restarting is \$250. It is the one thing that decides whether a site takes three weeks or three months.

If a website builder is genuinely the better fit for you, I will say so on the first call.